

Contents

1 Strategy	2
1.1 Strategic Management Journal	2
1.1.1 1. Flying high or crashing down: Pre-entry knowledge, post-entry learning, and the distribution of startup performance	2
1.1.2 2. The university versus region effect: A variance decomposition of academic spin-off performance	2
1.1.3 3. Lone genius or lonely fool? Exploring the viability of solo-founding in entrepreneurship	3
1.1.4 4. Do multinational enterprises from developed and emerging economies differ in their price discrimination strategies? Evidence from Africa	4
1.2 Academy of Management Journal	4
1.2.1 1. Corporate Venture Capital Knowledge Obsolescence and Portfolio Firm Innovation	4
1.3 Academy of Management Review	5
1.3.1 1. Extending the Study of Competitive Externalities in Acquisitions: A Reply to "Boundary Conditions and Juxtaposition of Externalities"	5
1.3.2 2. Interpreting the Chorus: A Reply to "Leaders on the Other Side of Voice: Extending Black et al.' S Integrative Theory of Collective Voice"	5
1.3.3 3. The Origins and Evolution of Red, Blue, and Purple Employee Populations: A Theory of How Organizations Become Ideologically Skewed	6
1.4 Administrative Science Quarterly	6
1.4.1 1. The Promise–Risk Balance: Recalibrating Design Choices and Strategic Framing Following Catastrophic Innovation Failure*	6
1.4.2 2. Remote Work and Hiring Requirements: Cross-Country Evidence from Job Postings	7
1.4.3 3. Getting in the Door vs. Winning It All: How Gendered Outcomes Change Across Evaluation Stages in Entrepreneurship	7
1.4.4 4. Hannah Ritchie. Not the End of the World: How We Can Be the First Generation to Build a Sustainable Planet	8
1.4.5 5. Lilac Nachum and Attila Yaprak (Eds). The Historical Evolution of International Business: Growth Trajectory of an Academic Field of Study	8
1.5 Organization Science	8
1.5.1 1. Unraveling the Impact of Distributed Government Authority: Evidence from OSHA Oversight of Defense Contractors	8
1.5.2 2. Outshining Your Rival: Interpersonal Rivalry and Its Effects on Organizational Contributions	9
2 Innovation & Entrepreneurship	9
2.1 Entrepreneurship Theory and Practice	9
2.1.1 1. Baby Boom or Baby Bust? Parental Leave of TMT Members and Innovation in SMEs	9
2.1.2 2. Self-Employment Entry Across Family Transitions: Household Capability Reallocation Over the Life Course	10
2.1.3 3. Commitment Issues? How Investors Perceive and React to the Different Roles of Hybrid Entrepreneurs	10

2.1.4	4. Fabricating Effectual Networks: How Hybrid Logics Collectivize Voice for Co-Creation in Makerspaces	11
2.1.5	5. Is the Venture Growth-Survival Relationship Inverted U-Shaped or Not? A Replication and Extension	11
2.1.6	6. Can Lack-of-Fit Penalties Apply to Male Entrepreneurs? Equity Fundraising in Femtech	12
2.1.7	7. Is Self-Employment a Career Trap? A Large-Scale Field Experiment in the Labor Market	12
2.1.8	8. Crowd Evaluations of Entrepreneurs with Physical Disabilities: Stereotype Subtyping through the Lens of Benevolent Ableism	12
2.2	Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal	13
2.2.1	1. Toward a theory of Bayesian experimentation in early-stage ventures	13
2.2.2	2. Dancing to multiple tunes: Establishing legitimacy with first-time and repeat backers in crowdfunding campaigns	14
3	General Management	14
3.1	Academy of Management Annals	14
3.1.1	1. Board Effectiveness in Contemporary Organizations: Integrating The Board Practitioner and Scholarly Literatures	14
3.1.2	2. Experimentation in Organizations: An Integrative Review	15
3.2	Journal of Management Studies	15
3.2.1	1. Signalling servant leadership: How followers interpret leader behaviours	15
3.2.2	2. Fly Solo, Then Return Home? Offspring's Entrepreneurship Experience and their Future As Family Business Successors	16
3.2.3	3. The Price of Prominence: How CEO Extraversion Influences Board Attributions and the Dismissal-Performance Sensitivity	16
3.2.4	4. Property Rights Theory, Justice, and Reciprocity	17
3.2.5	5. From Platform Design to Attention Governance: Rethinking Social Media Externalities	17
3.2.6	6. When Doing Good Feels Wrong: The Dual Influence of Perceived Organizational Opportunism on Employee CSR Behaviour	18
3.2.7	7. The Great Temporal Divide: How Top Management Team Temporal Faultlines and Dominant Subgroups Shape Firm Innovativeness in Iran	19
3.3	Journal of Management	19
3.3.1	1. There' s More Than Meets the Eye: Assessing the Impact of Immigrants on Firm Environmental Performance	19
3.3.2	2. Conflict-Situated Cooperation: How Israeli and Palestinian IT Professionals Give Meaning to Cooperating Under Ethnonational Conflict	20
3.3.3	3. A Watched Blossom Seldom Blooms: Board Interlocks and Digital Business Model Innovation	20
3.3.4	4. How Racioethnic Equity Contributes To Organizational Functioning	21

1. Flying high or crashing down: Pre-entry knowledge, post-entry learning, and the distribution of startup performance

Authors: Rajshree Agarwal, Benjamin Campbell, Seth Carnahan, Joonkyu Choi

DOI: [10.1002/smj.70101](https://doi.org/10.1002/smj.70101)

Published: 2026-05-27

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Strategic Management, Organizational Learning
- **Theories:** Human Capital Theory, Epistemic Uncertainty, Selection Threshold Model, Post-entry Learning

Abstract:

Research Summary: We examine variation in high- technology startups' performance based on founders' pre-entry experiences by developing a formal model and using confidential employee-employer linked microdata from the United States to examine the empirical consistency of the model propositions. The model posits that relative to insiders, a lack of industry- specific experience creates greater epistemic uncertainty regarding optimal business models at time of entry for outsiders and thus, higher post-entry adjustment costs associated with necessary pivots. Consequently, outsiders have a higher selection threshold for the value-creation potential of the underlying technical Authors contributed equally and are listed alphabetically. Opinions and conclusions herein are those of the authors and do not necessarily represent the views of the U.S. Census Bureau or of the Board of Governors or its staff. We gratefully acknowledge financial support from the Kauffman Foundation and National Science Foundation. This research uses data from the Census Bureau's Longitudinal Employer Household Dynamics Program, which was partially supported by the following National Science Foundation Grants SES-9978093, SES-0339191, and ITR-0427889; National Institute on Aging Grant AG018854; and grants from the Alfred P. Sloan Foundation. All results have been reviewed to ensure that no confidential information is disclosed. Disclosure review numbers 2017-0331, 2019-7818, 2019-0930, and 2024-0807. Received: 9 March 2026 Revised: 9 March 2026 Accepted: 13 March 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70101 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Management Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–35. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 ideas. Together, these mechanisms yield propositions that relative to insiders, outsiders have lower odds of survival on average, but higher growth and probability of being acquired. The empirical results indicate strong and robust support for these propositions. Managerial Summary: Our paper showcases that individuals contemplating entrepreneurial opportunities outside their industry of employment face higher uncertainty in configuring their business model at time of entry relative to those with industry-specific experience. This results in higher adjustment costs for implementing pivots resulting from post-entry learning and a higher likelihood that they will terminate operations. To offset these higher risks, individuals venture outside their industry only if their technical ideas have higher value-creation potential. This implies that outsider startups are more likely to exit (including through acquisitions),...

□ Agarwal - Flying high or crashing down Pre-entry knowledge, post-entry learning, and the d.pdf

2. The university versus region effect: A variance decomposition of academic spin-off performance

Authors: Julia Mokhtar, Mirjam Knockaert, Tom Vanacker, Paul Bliese

DOI: [10.1002/smj.70095](https://doi.org/10.1002/smj.70095)

Published: 2026-05-22

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Academic Entrepreneurship, Regional Ecosystems, Strategic Management

- **Theories:** Variance Decomposition, Multi-level Theory, Innovation Ecosystems

Abstract:

Research Summary: Academic spin-off (ASO) performance has been studied in relation to either specific university-level or regional-level characteristics. However, ASOs originate from universities, which are embedded in regional ecosystems. This nested structure can create an attribution problem when either level is studied in isolation. Consequently, the relative importance of these two different levels for ASO performance has remained ambiguous. To address this ambiguity, we rely on multi-level modeling and use a novel, hand-collected dataset of 3164 ASOs founded between 2010 and 2019 from 212 universities nested within 99 European regions. We find that the region effect matters for about 27% for Return on Assets and 16% for Sales, whereas the university effect is negligible. Our study contributes to research at the nexus of academic entrepreneurship and variance decomposition in strategy. Managerial Summary: Academic spin-offs (ASOs) bring innovations from the university to the market, thereby potentially generating new sales, employment, and value. However, once formed, their performance Received: 31 March 2023 Revised: 12 March 2026 Accepted: 2 April 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70095 Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–23. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj © 2026 John Wiley & Sons Ltd. 1 prospects vary significantly, and understanding this variance is important for entrepreneurs and policymakers alike. Our findings from a new European dataset reveal that the region effect matters for ASO performance, but the university effect is negligible. This evidence does not imply that universities lack importance; rather, it suggests that universities in a region may have a collective impact that diffuses into regional resources and networks. Our evidence highlights the importance of fostering a supportive regional ecosystem. **K E Y W O R D S** academic spin-off, firm performance, multi-level, region, variance decomposition 1 |

□ Mokhtar - The university versus region effect A variance decomposition of academic spin-of.pdf

3. Lone genius or lonely fool? Exploring the viability of solo-founding in entrepreneurship

Authors: Travis Howell, Todd A. Hall

DOI: [10.1002/smj.70103](https://doi.org/10.1002/smj.70103)

Published: 2026-05-22

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Strategic Human Capital, Founding Teams
- **Theories:** Strategic Human Capital, Resource-Based View, Team Theory

Abstract:

Research Summary: The conventional wisdom both in research and in practice is that entrepreneurs need co-founders, as they bring crucial resources to new ventures. Yet, this same work also suggests that co-founders introduce destructive conflict, potentially creating as many problems as they solve. Surprisingly, little work examines the counterfactual—that is, the conditions under which solo-founding is a viable approach. In this paper, we address this gap. We perform two studies; one using data from Y Combinator’s renowned accelerator program, and another using large-scale data from Crunchbase. Across these studies, we find that the solo founder disadvantage is partially attenuated when the founder has either broad or deep experience, or both (i.e., “T-shaped skills”). Overall, our paper contributes to the literatures on founding teams and strategic human capital. Managerial Summary: Co-founders are beneficial to startups because they bring needed skillsets, knowledge, connections, and other resources. At the same time, however, co-founders also introduce the potential for interpersonal conflict between the entrepreneur and co-founders. Thus, in some cases, co-founders may create as many or more problems as they solve. Surprisingly, very little research examines solo founders. In this paper, we examine the conditions under which Received: 6 October 2025 Revised: 12 February 2026 Accepted: 11 May 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70103 All rights reserved, including rights for text and data mining and training of artificial intelligence technologies or similar technologies. © 2026 John Wiley & Sons Ltd. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–33. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 solo founding is a viable approach. We find evidence of multiple ways in which solo founders can begin to overcome their performance disadvantages and achieve performance closer to that of co-founded ventures. **K E Y W O R D S** entrepreneurship, founders, founding teams, hazard models, new venture performance 1 |

□ Howell - Lone genius or lonely fool Exploring the viability of solo-founding in

4. Do multinational enterprises from developed and emerging economies differ in their price discrimination strategies? Evidence from Africa

Authors: Arzi Adbi, Ajay Bhaskarabhatla, Andrew Delios

DOI: [10.1002/smj.70102](https://doi.org/10.1002/smj.70102)

Published: 2026-05-20

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** International Business, Strategic Management, Non-market Strategy
- **Theories:** Institutional Theory, Stakeholder Theory, Reputational Risk, Signaling Theory

Abstract:

Research Summary: Do multinational enterprises from developed (DMNEs) and emerging (EMNEs) economies differ in their price discrimination strategies in Sub-Saharan Africa? Using an abductive approach, we analyze novel data from laundry detergent markets in Cameroon, Ghana, and Ivory Coast, where frugal products are widely consumed. We find that, compared to EMNEs, DMNEs charge smaller price premia for frugal relative to non-frugal products by 21%–28%. We examine several plausible explanations and find suggestive evidence that the greater visibility of DMNEs motivates them to exercise caution in setting greater price premia for their frugal relative to non-frugal products. Even within DMNEs, more visible firms charge smaller price premia than less visible firms. Managerial Summary: Our investigation reveals an intriguing difference in the pricing strategies of multinational enterprises selling basic consumer goods in Africa. We analyze laundry detergent products sold in Cameroon, Ghana, and Ivory Coast. We find that, compared to multinational enterprises from developed Received: 5 January 2024 Revised: 9 April 2026 Accepted: 5 May 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70102 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial-NoDerivs License, which permits use and distribution in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited, the use is non-commercial and no modifications or adaptations are made. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Management Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–30. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 economies (DMNEs), those from emerging economies (EMNEs) charge materially higher price premium on small packs relative to large packs. A key driver appears to be differences in exposure to reputational risk. DMNEs are more cautious about pricing small packs in ways that could be perceived as exploiting resource-constrained consumers. Even within DMNEs, more visible firms charge smaller price premium than less visible ones. These findings highlight that pricing decisions for frugal products entail social considerations, as firms differ in their exposure to stakeholder scrutiny. KEYWORDS abductive approach, Africa, DMNEs, EMNEs, multinational enterprises 1 |

□ Adbi - Do multinational enterprises from developed and emerging economies differ in the.pdf

Academy of Management Journal

1. Corporate Venture Capital Knowledge Obsolescence and Portfolio Firm Innovation

Authors: Umit Ozmel, Yoon Jung (Jenny) Kwon, David H. Hsu

DOI: [10.5465/amj.2023.1020](https://doi.org/10.5465/amj.2023.1020)

Published: 2026-05-29

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Corporate Venture Capital, Innovation Management, Strategic Management
- **Theories:** Knowledge-Based View, Appropriation Theory, Network Theory, Agency Theory

Abstract:

Using the setting of corporate venture capital (CVC) investments, we examine how the knowledge obsolescence of a venture's interorganizational partner shapes the venture's innovation performance. We conceptualize knowledge obsolescence as the declining relevance of a firm's knowledge base as technological domains evolve. We suggest and find that as a venture's CVC investor becomes more knowledge-obsolete,

it develops stronger incentives to appropriate the venture's technologies and intellectual property to renew its own knowledge base—what we term obsolescence-induced appropriation incentives. Our analyses also reveal key contingencies. The negative association between CVC knowledge obsolescence and the venture's innovation is (a) amplified when the CVC's parent firm faces intense competitive pressures, and (b) mitigated when the venture is backed by independent venture capitalists with high network prominence. Robustness tests further show that strong intellectual property protection regimes attenuate this negative association, providing further support for the existence of obsolescence-induced appropriation incentives by the venture's interorganizational partner. By adopting a temporal perspective on partners' evolving knowledge relevance, this study hence clarifies when interorganizational ties may hinder innovation and how shifts in a partner's knowledge base reshape the partner's appropriation incentives.

□ ozmel-et-al-2026-corporate-venture-capital-knowledge-obsolescence-and-portfolio-firm-inno

Academy of Management Review

1. Extending the Study of Competitive Externalities in Acquisitions: A Reply to “Boundary Conditions and Juxtaposition of Externalities”

Authors: Jaideep Anand, Philipp Meyer-Doyle, Benjamin W. Blunck

DOI: [10.5465/amr.2026.0535](https://doi.org/10.5465/amr.2026.0535)

Published: 2026-05-29

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Strategy, Mergers and Acquisitions, Competitive Dynamics
- **Theories:** Value Capture Framework, Competitive Externalities, Information Asymmetry, Game Theory

Abstract:

While acquisitions are a popular means of corporate development, it is often uncertain whether acquirers capture positive value. This uncertainty is further compounded by the profound competitive implications associated with acquisitions. To shed more light on these implications, we develop the concepts of negative and positive competitive externalities in acquisitions in more detail and outline a framework that explains which acquisitions give rise to which competitive externalities. We then predict their impact on acquirers' and rivals' value capture under different synergy and information conditions, providing several insights: First, when negative competitive externalities exist, when no bidder can create unique synergies and bidders are aware of the synergies and externalities, bidders engage in value-destroying acquisitions to avoid negative externalities. A bidder with unique synergies only captures positive value if the unique synergies exceed a rival's negative competitive externalities. Second, information advantages of one bidder over others are a key factor enabling positive value capture even when competitive externalities exist. Third, faced with positive competitive externalities, bidders may lack incentives to acquire even if further synergies exist, and the most capable acquirer may not capture the most value. Our paper sheds light on competitive externalities in acquisitions and provides important insights for strategic management research.

□ Anand - Competitive Externalities in Acquisitions.pdf

2. Interpreting the Chorus: A Reply to “Leaders on the Other Side of Voice: Extending Black et al.’ S Integrative Theory of Collective Voice”

Authors: Nathan A. Black, Daniel W. Newton, Jennifer D. Nahrgang

DOI: [10.5465/amr.2026.0481](https://doi.org/10.5465/amr.2026.0481)

Published: 2026-05-26

Abstract not available. □ black-et-al-2026-interpreting-the-chorus-a-reply-to-leaders-on-the-oth

3. The Origins and Evolution of Red, Blue, and Purple Employee Populations: A Theory of How Organizations Become Ideologically Skewed

Authors: Yasir Dewan, Abhinav Gupta, Donald C. Hambrick

DOI: [10.5465/amr.2025.0229](https://doi.org/10.5465/amr.2025.0229)

Published: 2026-05-18

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Theory, Human Resource Management, Organizational Behavior, Political Ideology
- **Theories:** Attraction-Selection-Attrition (ASA) Framework, Imprinting Theory, Institutional Theory, Societal Polarization

Abstract:

Research has shown that employee populations of some firms exhibit distinct ideological hues, consisting overwhelmingly of either left-leaning or right-leaning individuals, and that the implications of such skews are substantial. However, little is known about how ideologically skewed employee populations come to be. We present a theory that predicts the degree to which a firm's employee population will be ideologically skewed, rather than normally distributed, at a given point in the firm's lifespan. Our theory unfolds in three stages. First, we argue that founding conditions—societal polarization, ideological skewness of relevant labor markets, and founder ideology—determine whether a firm's initial workforce will be ideologically skewed. Second, we propose that if an ideological skew initially emerges, attraction–selection–attrition (ASA) processes reinforce the skew, causing it to increase over time. Third, we highlight that ASA-driven outcomes are not deterministic; instead, emergent post-founding contingencies—such as shifts in the salience of ideologies, pressures to be mainstream, and reversal mandates—can either exacerbate or dampen ideological skews. By identifying these contingencies, we explain why some firms become bright “red” or “blue” while others are “purple,” and offer a foundation for understanding the interplay between societal polarization and ideological leanings of employee populations.

□ Dewan - The Origins and Evolution of Red, Blue, and Purple Employee Populations
A Theory.pdf

Administrative Science Quarterly

1. The Promise–Risk Balance: Recalibrating Design Choices and Strategic Framing Following Catastrophic Innovation Failure*

Authors: Sen Chai, Anil R. Doshi, Luciana Silvestri, Tiona Zuzul

DOI: [10.1177/00018392261446610](https://doi.org/10.1177/00018392261446610)

Published: 2026-05-19

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Innovation Management, Crisis Management, Organizational Theory
- **Theories:** Strategic Framing, Organizational Legitimacy, Organizational Learning, Promise-Risk Balance

Abstract:

Catastrophic innovation failure derails firms' innovation process and threatens their legitimacy. Prior research has analyzed internal and external responses to failure separately, focusing either on intra-firm learning and failure remediation or on efforts to sustain stakeholder support. Research on these responses' co-evolution has been notably absent. We examine how a firm jointly recalibrated internal design choices and external strategic framing following catastrophic innovation failure, through a study of Virgin Galactic's 2014 test flight crash. We introduce and develop the concept of the ‘promise–risk balance’: a state in which the uncertainty inherent to innovation and the framing communicated to stakeholders stand in generative tension and jointly support the innovation process. Catastrophic innovation failure disrupts this balance. We map Virgin Galactic's recalibration of risk via internal design choices and recalibration of promise via external framing as interdependent levers to restore balance. We show that design choices

aimed at de-risking technology can have adverse effects on a firm's capabilities, externally dampening promise. Following failure, strategic reframing must bring the firm's external message in line with actual capabilities and inspire stakeholder support. Recognizing and managing interdependencies between design choices and strategic framing is crucial to the continuity of the innovation process and firm survival. 1 McGill University 2 UCL School of Management 3 Independent Researcher 4 Harvard Business School * All authors contributed equally and are listed in alphabetical order Corresponding author: Sen Chai, McGill University, 1001 rue Sherbrooke Ouest, Montreal, Quebec H3A 1G5, Canada Email: sen.chai@mcgill.ca

□ Chai - The Promise–Risk Balance Recalibrating Design Choices and Strategic Framing Foll.pdf

2. Remote Work and Hiring Requirements: Cross-Country Evidence from Job Postings

Authors: Shinan Wang, Letian Zhang, Zhenyu Liao

DOI: [10.1177/00018392261450609](https://doi.org/10.1177/00018392261450609)

Published: 2026-05-29

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Human Resource Management, Labor Economics, Organizational Design, Future of Work
- **Theories:** Skill Upgrading, Human Capital Theory, Information Economics, Transaction Cost Economics

Abstract:

In this article, we show that remote work is associated with higher skill and qualification requirements in hiring. Drawing on qualitative interviews, we identify several mechanisms through which remote work raises hiring standards. By reducing face-to-face interaction and real-time communication, remote work makes training and employee support more challenging, expands the pool of applicants, and leads employers to rely more on quantifiable metrics. We tested these ideas by analyzing over 50 million job postings from 28 European countries between 2018 and 2021 and found that the shift to remote work is associated with a higher number of required skills and greater work experience for a job. These findings indicate that remote work contributes to skill upgrading in the labor market.

□ Wang - Remote Work and Hiring Requirements Cross-Country Evidence from Job Postings.pdf

3. Getting in the Door vs. Winning It All: How Gendered Outcomes Change Across Evaluation Stages in Entrepreneurship

Authors: Tristan L. Botelho, Ethan J. Poskanzer

DOI: [10.1177/00018392261442931](https://doi.org/10.1177/00018392261442931)

Published: 2026-05-30

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Organizational Behavior, Gender Studies, Strategic Human Capital
- **Theories:** Status Characteristics Theory, Signaling Theory, Risk Aversion, Stakes-driven Gender Inequality

Abstract:

Research has consistently found that organizational evaluations produce gendered outcomes. We advance understanding of this inequality by examining how multistage evaluations—a common organizational design feature—shape gendered evaluative disparities. We integrate and extend research on evaluations, status, and inequality to theorize how gendered outcomes can vary between stages within a single, unified evaluation process—what we term “stakes-driven gender inequality.” Our theoretical framework centers on a ubiquitous feature of organizational multistage evaluation processes that is missing from prior theoretical accounts: escalating stakes across stages via increasingly binding commitments and rising cost of wrong selections. We conceptualize two stylized stages within the same evaluation process: a short listing stage

(a preliminary selection of candidates for further consideration) and a winners stage (in which final, binding selections are made). Using data from a large multistage startup competition, we test our theory and find that female-led startups are 18.7 percent more likely than male-led startups to be selected in the shortlisting stage but 30.7 percent less likely to be selected in the winners stage. Mechanism tests in the shortlisting stage are most consistent with female-led startups being assessed as higher quality, whereas in the winners stage, we find evidence consistent with gendered performance expectations and evaluators' risk aversion.

□ Botelho - Getting in the Door vs. Winning It All How Gendered Outcomes Change Across Evalu.pdf

4. Hannah Ritchie. Not the End of the World: How We Can Be the First Generation to Build a Sustainable Planet

Authors: Michael Lenox

DOI: [10.1177/00018392261453354](https://doi.org/10.1177/00018392261453354)

Published: 2026-05-16

Abstract not available. □ Lenox - Hannah Ritchie. Not the End of the World How We Can Be the First Generation to B.pdf

5. Lilac Nachum and Attila Yaprak (Eds). The Historical Evolution of International Business: Growth Trajectory of an Academic Field of Study

Authors: Sorin M. S. Krammer

DOI: [10.1177/00018392261449249](https://doi.org/10.1177/00018392261449249)

Published: 2026-05-27

Abstract not available. □ Krammer - Lilac Nachum and Attila Yaprak (Eds). The Historical Evolution of International.pdf

Organization Science

1. Unraveling the Impact of Distributed Government Authority: Evidence from OSHA Oversight of Defense Contractors

Authors: Mirzokhidjon Abdurakhmonov, Jifeng Yu, Wei Shi

DOI: [10.1287/orsc.2024.19026](https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2024.19026)

Published: 2026-05-26

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Political Activity, Non-market Strategy, Public Policy
- **Theories:** Contracting Theory, Agency Theory, Distributed Authority

Abstract:

Corporate political activity (CPA) research often focuses on single-government interactions, overlooking the complexities of distributed government authority. Drawing from contracting literature, our study explores the implications of distributed government authority for firm outcomes in the CPA arena. Specifically, we investigate how different types of contractual arrangements with resource-granting agencies—fixed-price contracts (which allocate risk to firms) versus cost-plus contracts (which shift risk to resource providers)—affect the frequency of discretionary oversight by independent regulatory agencies. Fixed-price contracts, with their predefined budgets and extensive preaward vetting, alleviate oversight agencies' concerns about contractor opportunism, leading to reduced oversight intensity. In contrast, cost-plus contracts, with their reimbursement-based structure and operational flexibility, necessitate increased oversight due to risks of contractor opportunism. We further examine how two situational factors—contract duration and negative media coverage of labor issues—moderate these relationships. Using data on U.S. Department of Defense contracts and Occupational Safety and Health Administration oversight, our study advances the CPA literature

by highlighting the importance of considering the intricate dynamics of distributed authority in shaping the returns from corporate political activities. Supplemental Material: The online appendices are available at <https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2024.19026>.

□ Abdurakhmonov - Unraveling the Impact of Distributed Government Authority Evidence from OSHA Ove.pdf

2. Outshining Your Rival: Interpersonal Rivalry and Its Effects on Organizational Contributions

Authors: Arne Thomas, Henning Piezunka, Linus Dahlander

DOI: [10.1287/orsc.2024.18649](https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2024.18649)

Published: 2026-05-20

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Strategic Human Capital, Micro-foundations of Strategy
- **Theories:** Social Comparison Theory, Rivalry Theory, Cross-level Theory

Abstract:

We theorize that competing with an interpersonal rival from another organization has a divergent cross-level effect: employees increase their visible individual contributions, but their total contributions to the organization decrease. Striving to outshine their rivals, employees focus on visible individual contributions that are easily observable and readily attributable. We advance three mechanisms through which this focus can reduce employees' total contributions to the organization: crowding out of less visible contributions, excessive risk taking, and organizational overreliance. Using data from the National Basketball Association, we find support for the hypothesized divergent effect and show that the results are robust to multiple model specifications, operationalizations, and alternative explanations. Our results suggest that employees respond to their rivals' visible contributions, using them as a benchmark for social comparison. Exploring the mechanisms, we find support for excessive risk taking and organizational overreliance, but mixed evidence for crowding out of less visible contributions. Our study advances emergent cross-level perspectives on rivalry by highlighting that its positive and negative effects are unevenly distributed across organizational levels—the rivalry-induced focus on visible individual contributions comes at the organization's expense. Open Access Statement: This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International License. You are free to copy, distribute, transmit and adapt this work, but you must attribute this work as "Organization Science. Copyright © 2026 The Author(s). <https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2024.18649>, used under a Creative Commons Attribution License: <https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/>." Supplemental Material: The online appendix is available at <https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2024.18649>.

□ Thomas - Outshining Your Rival Interpersonal Rivalry and Its Effects on Organizational Co.pdf

Innovation & Entrepreneurship

Entrepreneurship Theory and Practice

1. Baby Boom or Baby Bust? Parental Leave of TMT Members and Innovation in SMEs

Authors: Lucia Naldi, Evila Piva, Massimo Baù

DOI: [10.1177/10422587261440307](https://doi.org/10.1177/10422587261440307)

Published: 2026-05-15

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Innovation Management, Entrepreneurship, Upper Echelons
- **Theories:** Upper Echelons Theory, Role Theory, Behavioral Integration

Abstract:

We investigate the effect of parental leave taken by top management team (TMT) members on innovation

outputs in small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs). By analyzing a large sample of Swedish SMEs, we find that the length of parental leave taken by TMT members has a positive effect on SME innovation outputs. This effect is stronger for smaller and longer-tenured TMTs, as these TMTs likely exhibit greater behavioral integration. Such integration can support TMT members in mitigating role conflicts and leveraging the role enhancement benefits connected to performing multiple roles during and after leave. These results contribute to the literature and offer valuable practical insights.

□ Naldi - Baby Boom or Baby Bust Parental Leave of TMT Members and Innovation in SMEs.pdf

2. Self-Employment Entry Across Family Transitions: Household Capability Reallocation Over the Life Course

Authors: Hien Thu Tran

DOI: [10.1177/10422587261447788](https://doi.org/10.1177/10422587261447788)

Published: 2026-05-19

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Sociology of Work, Labor Economics
- **Theories:** Life-course Theory, Household Bargaining Perspective, Capability Approach

Abstract:

This study examines how major family transitions—marriage, childbirth, divorce, widowhood, and the co-occurrence of marriage and childbirth within the same observation interval—are associated with entry into self-employment as households reallocate risk, care, and income responsibilities. Using longitudinal Canadian data from the Longitudinal and International Study of Adults (2012–2020), it draws on life-course theory, household bargaining perspectives, and the capability approach to conceptualize self-employment entry as a process of contingent capability reallocation rather than simply a reflection of stable entrepreneurial preferences. The findings show that identical life events generate divergent entry responses across gendered breadwinner roles, caregiving demands, and life stage. Marriage and childbirth are positively associated with entry on average, but these associations are contingent: marriage is most strongly associated with entry among newly married secondary-earning women, while childbirth suppresses entry for primary-earning mothers and attenuates for new fathers as caregiving intensity rises. Divorce shows no uniform association: it is positively associated with childcare-expense responsibility but negatively associated with prior primary-earner status. Widowhood is associated with reduced entry, with no working-age moderation. Finally, the co-occurrence of marriage and childbirth within the same biennial interval is associated with higher entry than either transition alone.

□ Tran - Self-Employment Entry Across Family Transitions Household Capability Reallocation.

3. Commitment Issues? How Investors Perceive and React to the Different Roles of Hybrid Entrepreneurs

Authors: Stratos Baloutsos, Angeliki Karagiannaki

DOI: [10.1177/10422587261450578](https://doi.org/10.1177/10422587261450578)

Published: 2026-05-25

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Entrepreneurial Finance, Venture Capital
- **Theories:** Role Congruity Theory, Signaling Theory, Identity Theory

Abstract:

Hybrid entrepreneurs who retain salaried or academic roles are often viewed as insufficiently committed by investors. Yet, maintaining a hybrid employment status can also be a strategic pathway into high-growth venturing. Drawing on Role Congruity Theory, we examine how Venture Capital funds and angel investors evaluate hybrid founders and how founders adapt over time. Using 17 semi-structured interviews with in-

vestors and hybrid entrepreneurs in two European ecosystems and two longitudinal case studies of research-intensive ventures, we inductively theorize hybrid venturing as a congruity alignment trajectory and derive pro-positions linking investor role expectations, founder adaptation, and ecosystem support structures.

□ Baloutsos - Commitment Issues How Investors Perceive and React to the Different Roles of Hyb.pdf

4. Fabricating Effectual Networks: How Hybrid Logics Collectivize Voice for Co-Creation in Makerspaces

Authors: Russell E. Browder

DOI: [10.1177/10422587261447793](https://doi.org/10.1177/10422587261447793)

Published: 2026-05-15

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Institutional Theory, Innovation Ecosystems, Organizational Theory
- **Theories:** Effectuation, Institutional Logics, Social Interaction Mechanisms, Co-creation

Abstract:

Effectuation research posits that effectual networks are composed of self-selecting stakeholders who purchase voice to gain influence in how the effectual process proceeds when they commit to co-create. However, entrepreneurship scholars wrestle with theorizing the social action underlying a theory originally based on the individual decision-making of experts and, specifically, explaining how voice emerges prior to commitment to influence effectual network formation. This study combines the literatures on effectuation and hybrid institutional logics to examine how intermediaries can shape the creation of effectual networks among their members. Through a multiple case study of six makerspaces, the findings reveal how voice emerges and becomes collectivized in the transition from informal collaboration to co-creation. Makerspaces with a high degree of hybrid logics support voice emergence through three social interaction mechanisms: project socializing, market logic embedding, and community logic extending. The study builds a model of effectual network formation via voice emergence moderated by logic hybridity, thereby sharpening the parameters of effectual networks pertaining to voice and co-creation.

□ Browder - Fabricating Effectual Networks How Hybrid Logics Collectivize Voice for Co-Creat.pdf

5. Is the Venture Growth-Survival Relationship Inverted U-Shaped or Not? A Replication and Extension

Authors: Yassine Lamrani Abou Ellassad, Giuseppe Criaco, Justin J.P. Jansen, Tom J.M. Mom

DOI: [10.1177/10422587261441597](https://doi.org/10.1177/10422587261441597)

Published: 2026-05-19

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Strategic Management, Venture Growth
- **Theories:** Growth-Survival Relationship, Organizational Ecology, Lifetime Growth Perspective

Abstract:

This study revisits the assumption that moderate growth offers the most reliable path to new venture survival. Adopting a lifetime growth perspective, we distinguish genuine failure from strategic or neutral exits to better understand the growth-survival relationship. Using 246,831 venture-year observations from 52,277 Dutch startups (2007–2019), we replicate and extend prior research. While moderate annualized growth enhances short-term survival, our extension reveals a contrasting long-term pattern: ventures with either low or high lifetime growth exhibit the greatest survival likelihood. These findings reconcile competing perspectives and highlight how ventures need to navigate short- and long-term pressures to survive.

□ Ellassad - Is the Venture Growth-Survival Relationship Inverted U-Shaped or Not A

6. Can Lack-of-Fit Penalties Apply to Male Entrepreneurs? Equity Fundraising in Femtech

Authors: Hana Milanov, Benedikt David Christian Seigner, Erik Lundmark

DOI: [10.1177/10422587261444752](https://doi.org/10.1177/10422587261444752)

Published: 2026-05-20

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Entrepreneurial Finance, Gender Studies, Sociology of Markets
- **Theories:** Lack-of-Fit Theory, Moral Legitimacy, Embodied Task Competence, Gender Stereotypes

Abstract:

Persistent evidence of a male advantage in equity fundraising has led entrepreneurship scholars to assume that while women face fit penalties in male-typed industries, men are exempt from penalties in female-typed ones. Yet underlying sociological theory implies that lack-of-fit penalties would apply to both sexes. Analyzing 718 equity deals from 408 ventures in Femtech, we find that male CEOs raise smaller deal amounts than female CEOs. Post hoc analyses and interviews provide interpretive triangulation consistent with two plausible explanatory accounts, embodied task competence and moral legitimacy. This challenges the assumption that men are exempt from fit penalties in female-typed industries.

□ Milanov - Can Lack-of-Fit Penalties Apply to Male Entrepreneurs Equity Fundraising in Femt.pdf

7. Is Self-Employment a Career Trap? A Large-Scale Field Experiment in the Labor Market

Authors: Igor Asanov, Maria Mavlikeeva

DOI: [10.1177/10422587261440312](https://doi.org/10.1177/10422587261440312)

Published: 2026-05-20

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Human Resource Management, Labor Economics, Organizational Behavior
- **Theories:** Signaling Theory, Human Capital Theory, Behavioral Fit

Abstract:

We conduct a large-scale labor-market experiment using more than 8,000 fictitious résumés to uncover the demand-side mechanisms behind the adverse treatment of the self-employed entering wage employment. We find that, compared to wage earners, self-employed individuals face lower callback rates across industries and skill groups. This adverse treatment is concentrated in the lower-skilled, non-managerial market of associate professionals, with a 28% drop in callback. Results suggest that self-employment leads to the development of generalist skills (useful for managerial roles) at the cost of specialist skills. Furthermore, perceived behavioral fit of the self-employed seems to be penalized in associate positions.

□ Asanov - Is Self-Employment a Career Trap A Large-Scale Field Experiment in the Labor Mar.pdf

8. Crowd Evaluations of Entrepreneurs with Physical Disabilities: Stereotype Subtyping through the Lens of Benevolent Ableism

Authors: Silvia Stroe, Charlotta Sirén, Tom Vanacker

DOI: [10.1177/10422587261444756](https://doi.org/10.1177/10422587261444756)

Published: 2026-05-26

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Social Psychology, Entrepreneurial Finance, Diversity and Inclusion
- **Theories:** Stereotype Subtyping, Benevolent Ableism, Stereotype Content Model

Abstract:

We investigate how crowds evaluate pitches by entrepreneurs with versus without physical disabilities. Leveraging stereotype subtyping, we argue that entrepreneurs with physical disabilities are evaluated as a distinct subtype, rather than as people with disabilities or as conventional entrepreneurs. We hypothesize that benevolent ableism shapes how this subtype is evaluated, inflating both warmth and competence perceptions. Three experiments support our hypotheses, and key informant conversations with professional investors and entrepreneurs with disabilities corroborate the proposed mechanisms. Our findings contribute to unconventional entrepreneurship research by examining how bias can manifest as patronizing positivity rather than overt negative discrimination.

□ Stroe - Crowd Evaluations of Entrepreneurs with Physical Disabilities Stereotype Subtypi.pdf

Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal

1. Toward a theory of Bayesian experimentation in early-stage ventures

Authors: Andrea Contigiani, Lien Denoo, Márton Hablicsek

DOI: [10.1002/sej.70031](https://doi.org/10.1002/sej.70031)

Published: 2026-05-20

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Strategic Management, Decision Sciences
- **Theories:** Bayesian Decision Theory, Information Economics, Lean Startup Framework

Abstract:

Research Summary: The entrepreneurship literature has established the benefits of experimentation but has paid comparatively little attention to its costs. We develop a Bayesian model to illustrate the entrepreneurial choice between direct and experimental entry. We argue that performance depends on three mechanisms: information, adaptation, and appropriability. We show that experimental entry is not universally optimal and characterize the conditions under which each mechanism favors or undermines it. We further allow founders to hold biased prior beliefs, showing that greater bias increases the value of experimentation. Extending the baseline model to a multidimensional setting, we show that experimenting across different dimensions leads to a variety of counterintuitive insights. Our analysis produces a series of testable predictions and yields several implications for the broader entrepreneurship literature and practice. **Managerial Summary:** Should every startup run experiments before launching? The lean startup movement says yes—but the answer depends on factors often overlooked by founders and investors. Experimentation creates value when the market is genuinely uncertain and founders' beliefs are far from what customers want. It can backfire when feedback is too noisy to interpret, when pivoting is prohibitively costly, or when releasing an early product may Received: 2 October 2025 Revised: 2 May 2026 Accepted: 5 May 2026 DOI: 10.1002/sej.70031 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial-NoDerivs License, which permits use and distribution in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited, the use is non-commercial and no modifications or adaptations are made. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd on behalf of Strategic Management Society. Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal. 2026;1–34. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/sej 1 favor imitation. In settings where products have several significant features, which dimensions to experiment in matters as much as whether to experiment at all. Our findings offer guidance to entrepreneurs, investors, and policymakers designing the conditions that make experimentation feasible. **KEYWORDS** Bayesian modeling, commercialization, entrepreneurial strategy, experimentation, organizational learning 1 |

□ Contigiani - Toward a theory of Bayesian experimentation in early-stage ventures.pdf

2. Dancing to multiple tunes: Establishing legitimacy with first-time and repeat backers in crowdfunding campaigns

Authors: Stephanie Hepp, Alexander Vossen, Lien Denoo

DOI: [10.1002/sej.70029](https://doi.org/10.1002/sej.70029)

Published: 2026-05-19

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Crowdfunding, Strategic Management
- **Theories:** Legitimacy Theory, Signaling Theory, Reciprocity

Abstract:

Research Summary: Using 14,108 Kickstarter crowdfunding campaigns, we examine three strategies to gather support from first-time versus repeat backers: narrative distinctiveness aligning with backers' expectations of novelty, endorsement from Kickstarter staff, and campaign leadership's reciprocity of funding other campaigns. Staff endorsement is more strongly associated with support from first-time backers, while campaign leadership's reciprocity is associated primarily with repeat backers. Differences between first-time and repeat backers are evident in evaluating narrative distinctiveness: narratives distinct from past campaigns correlate positively with repeat backers and greater funding but negatively with first-time backers. Narratives distinct from live campaigns correlate positively with first-time backers but are associated with lower funding amounts. Our findings conceptualize differences between first-time and repeat backers that shape the associations between campaign legitimization strategies and backer support. Managerial Summary: This work examines how Kickstarter campaigns should be designed to attract both new people and existing community members. We test whether differences between these two target groups exist in evaluating commonly established "success factors" of campaigns: An endorsement from Kickstarter, the involvement of the campaign founder on the platform, and a campaign text highlighting the campaign's novel contributions. We find differences in all three between both groups and conclude with insights on how managers should design crowdfunding campaigns based on long-term goals and objectives. We also offer some implications for crowdfunding platforms, such as Kickstarter, in supporting content creators in attracting new backers, which aids with overall platform growth. **KEYWORDS** audience evaluation, crowdfunding, experience, legitimacy, optimal distinctiveness 1 |

□ Hepp - Dancing to multiple tunes Establishing legitimacy with first-time and repeat backers.pdf

General Management

Academy of Management Annals

1. Board Effectiveness in Contemporary Organizations: Integrating The Board Practitioner and Scholarly Literatures

Authors: Alessandra Capezio, Abolfazl Keshavarzsaleh, Roshis Krishna Shrestha

DOI: [10.5465/annals.2024.0069](https://doi.org/10.5465/annals.2024.0069)

Published: 2026-05-18

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Corporate Governance, Strategic Management, Organizational Theory
- **Theories:** Agency Theory, Resource Dependence Theory, Behavioral Theory of the Board, Teleological Process Model

Abstract:

Increasing shareholder and consumer activism, rapid technological developments, and broader social, geopolitical, and environmental discontinuities are reshaping understandings of board effectiveness in contemporary settings. Despite sustained interest in the topic, prescriptive practitioner-oriented writings and scholarly research provide insights that are incomplete and siloed. Scholarship on board effectiveness is extensive, yet it focuses narrowly on select dimensions of board effectiveness and often lags the contemporary challenges facing boards highlighted in practitioner-oriented literature. Conversely, easily accessible practitioner-oriented literature commonly used by boards and their advisors overlooks relevant scholarly research. Few efforts have been made to merge insights from both literatures to develop a more complete and shared understanding of board effectiveness. To address this gap, this review integrates empirical findings from board scholarship with prescriptions from practice to develop a unified conceptual model of board effectiveness. In doing so, it (1) reconceptualizes board effectiveness as a teleological process linking board attributes, processes, task actions, and outcomes, (2) clarifies the essential functions of boards in contemporary settings, and (3) foregrounds the importance of board micro-processes (i.e., internal practices, relational dynamics, and cognition). The review concludes by discussing the implications of our evidence-based conceptual model for board research and practice.

□ Capezio - Board Effectiveness in Contemporary Organizations Integrating The Board Practiti.pdf

2. Experimentation in Organizations: An Integrative Review

Authors: Leonardo Corbo, Riitta Katila, Božidar Vlačić

DOI: [10.5465/annals.2024.0287](https://doi.org/10.5465/annals.2024.0287)

Published: 2026-05-15

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Theory, Strategic Management, Innovation Management
- **Theories:** Evolutionary Theory (Variation-Selection-Retention), Organizational Learning, Problem-solving Perspective

Abstract:

Organizations have long relied on experiments to guide decision-making. Yet, a comprehensive synthesis of this rich and timely empirical literature remains lacking. In this integrative review, we identify two primary streams of research (problem-solving-based experimentation and causal inference-based experimentation), which we organize using the classic variation–selection–retention framework. The problem-solving stream emphasizes iterative experimentation, learning from failure, and navigating organizational challenges, while the causal inference stream focuses on sharp identification, structured experimental designs, and bounded experiments, each rooted in distinct disciplinary traditions. Despite the differences, these perspectives offer complementary insights into how organizations experiment, learn, and adapt. By analyzing 177 empirical studies across several disciplines and integrating these parallel streams, we develop a unifying framework that highlights the key drivers, processes, and outcomes of organizational experimentation. We conclude by outlining promising avenues for future research, including deeper retention in shaping experimental effectiveness and organizational learning, overcoming cognitive biases, expanding the scope of experiments to strategy, organizational design, and people processes, and the possibility of the two streams to cross-feed: problem-solving to generate broad hypotheses that causal inference sharpens, and causal inference experiments to trigger reframing of the problem-solving experiments.

□ Corbo - Experimentation in Organizations An Integrative Review.pdf

Journal of Management Studies

1. Signalling servant leadership: How followers interpret leader behaviours

Authors: Nathan Eva, Emily M. Hunter, Mitchell J. Neubert, Matthew Wood

DOI: [10.1111/joms.70116](https://doi.org/10.1111/joms.70116)

Published: 2026-05-29

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Leadership
- **Theories:** Signaling Theory, Servant Leadership Theory

Abstract:

Abstract Based on over 25 years of studies on servant leadership and multiple meta-analyses, we can safely say servant leadership positively affects individuals, teams, and organizations. Yet to reap these benefits, followers need to recognize leaders' behaviours as servant leadership. Because serving others requires time and energy, leaders may bear the costs of servant leadership without generating its benefits when those efforts go unrecognized. To address this concern, we draw on signalling theory to examine how leaders convey servant-oriented intentions through observable, costly behaviours. We test our hypotheses across three experiments, two conjoint analyses and one between-subjects video-based study to examine how followers interpret multiple leader and organizational signals. Our findings help explain the behaviour-perception mechanism through which leaders come to be recognized as servant leaders, while highlighting the complexities leaders face in signalling their intentions to followers. We show that leaders signal servant leadership through observable, costly service-oriented behaviours, such as helping followers grow and succeed, and need to engage in these behaviours frequently and consistently. We further show that the efficacy of these signals depends on followers' levels of prosocial motivation and the signalling environment in which the leader operates, providing evidence of how followers interpret multiple signals.

□ Eva - Signalling servant leadership How followers interpret leader behaviours.pdf

2. Fly Solo, Then Return Home? Offspring's Entrepreneurship Experience and their Future As Family Business Successors

Authors: Philipp Sieger, Jasper Brinkerink, Massimo Baù, Johan Karlsson, Alfredo De Massis

DOI: [10.1111/joms.70114](https://doi.org/10.1111/joms.70114)

Published: 2026-05-29

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Family Business, Entrepreneurship, Strategic Human Capital
- **Theories:** Human Capital Theory, Opportunity Cost Logic, Agency Theory

Abstract:

Abstract How does early-career entrepreneurship experience of family business offspring affect their likelihood of eventually taking over the established family firm? Considering family business succession as a dual-agency process, we draw on human capital theory and opportunity cost logic to theorize how the same early-career experience can have divergent implications for succession by simultaneously shaping parental preferences and offspring's choice. Using early-career entrepreneurship as a revealing case, we analyse parent-child successions involving 8274 potential successors in Sweden between 2001 and 2019 and find that entrepreneurship experience positively affects a child's succession likelihood. The strength of this effect, in turn, depends on the entrepreneurial offspring's opportunity costs of succession, which are shaped by characteristics of their venture and the family business.

□ Sieger - Fly Solo, Then Return Home Offspring's Entrepreneurship Experience and their Fut.pdf

3. The Price of Prominence: How CEO Extraversion Influences Board Attributions and the Dismissal-Performance Sensitivity

Authors: Jan C. Hennig, Sebastian Firk, Joseph S. Harrison, Hauke Meyer, Michael Wolff

DOI: [10.1111/joms.70122](https://doi.org/10.1111/joms.70122)

Published: 2026-05-28

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Governance, Organizational Behavior

- **Theories:** Attribution Theory, Upper Echelons Theory, Personality Theory

Abstract:

Abstract This study extends the socio-cognitive perspective on CEO dismissal by examining how CEOs' observed levels of extraversion influence the dismissal-performance sensitivity. Integrating attribution theory with research on personality and leadership, we theorize that more extraverted CEOs' prominence and perceived agency increase directors' attributions of performance to those individuals, thereby increasing their likelihood of dismissal when performance declines. We further posit that these dynamics are amplified in more complex industries and among shorter-tenured boards, where causal ambiguity and limited contextual knowledge increase reliance on simplifying cues such as personality-based attributions. Drawing on data from more than 4000 CEOs of S&P 1500 firms, and bolstered by supplemental tests from a vignette study, we find considerable support for our hypotheses. Our study extends attribution theory by identifying stable personality traits as enduring attributional cues that shape causal inferences in high-stakes governance settings. In doing so, it also contributes to the upper echelons literature and research on CEO-board dynamics by showing that executive traits influence not only firm actions and outcomes but also boards' collective evaluations of leadership.

□ Hennig - The Price of Prominence How CEO Extraversion Influences Board Attributions and t.pdf

4. Property Rights Theory, Justice, and Reciprocity

Authors: Douglas A. Bosse, Robert A. Phillips

DOI: [10.1111/joms.70119](https://doi.org/10.1111/joms.70119)

Published: 2026-05-22

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Theory, Strategic Management, Micro-foundations of Strategy
- **Theories:** Property Rights Theory, Social Exchange Theory, Justice and Reciprocity

Abstract:

Abstract

What really happens when situations arise that were not anticipated in contracts? The phenomenon of quiet quitting is an example of behaviour that is legally within the bounds of the contract governing a relationship while also generating variance in performance. Common and quantifiable examples of negative reciprocity from unhappy stakeholders towards firms are hard to account for using the language of ex ante and ex post contract negotiations at the heart of property rights theory (PRT). But how well does PRT describe and predict the contractual expectations of the parties regarding rights surrendered, value created, and the adequacy of each party's share? If some amount of ex post re-negotiation is unavoidable, we ask what contingencies determine the valence (value-creating vs. -destroying) and intensity of this re-negotiation using a well-established micro-behavioural lens—including concepts from social exchange theory—to better account for behaviours and outcomes not explained by PRT. We then specify how relational interdependence moderates the effect of these norms relative to PRT constructs. The result is a supplementary framework for understanding social norms and values as mechanisms for predicting behaviours and outcomes during ex post reevaluation—and ultimately for refining the role of the 'owner' in PRT.

□ Bosse - Property Rights Theory, Justice, and Reciprocity.pdf

5. From Platform Design to Attention Governance: Rethinking Social Media Externalities

Authors: Mirko Benischke, Corinne Post

DOI: [10.1111/joms.70118](https://doi.org/10.1111/joms.70118)

Published: 2026-05-19

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Innovation Ecosystems, Digital Governance

- **Theories:** Platform Theory, Attention Governance, Governance Theory

Abstract:

Abstract

Social media platforms have become central infrastructures through which information is produced, distributed, and contested in contemporary societies, with growing consequences for organizations, social interactions, and democracy. Yet, management and organization scholars tend to treat social media platforms as contexts rather than focal organizational entities. Synthesizing a Point Counterpoint debate, we argue that key disagreements across the debate articles can best be understood as a question of attention governance—who controls attention allocation, by what rules, and with what accountability. We show that despite divergent causal diagnoses (political capture, incentive distortion, or structural constraints), the contributions converge on attention considerations as a key factor through which social media externalities are produced. We synthesize the debate views through three unifying threads: an interest in how attention is valued and accumulated as currency and infrastructure, the recognition of a gradual shift of rule decision-making from collectively negotiated to algorithmically determined, and the reliance on increasingly thinner decision rules. We conclude with a governance research agenda to advance theory on social media platform externalities.

□ Benischke - From Platform Design to Attention Governance Rethinking Social Media Externaliti.pdf

6. When Doing Good Feels Wrong: The Dual Influence of Perceived Organizational Opportunism on Employee CSR Behaviour

Authors: Jintao Lu, Yue Li, Benjamin Laker, Chunyan Wang, Luu Duc Toan Huynh, Valerie Onyia Babatope, Malin Song

DOI: [10.1111/joms.70117](https://doi.org/10.1111/joms.70117)

Published: 2026-05-18

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Corporate Social Responsibility, Organizational Behavior, Micro-CSR
- **Theories:** Cognitive Dissonance Theory, Moral Disengagement Theory, Psychological Empowerment

Abstract:

Abstract Corporate social responsibility (CSR) initiatives are widely recognized for generating benefits such as enhanced reputation, stronger stakeholder trust, and improved employee engagement. These outcomes, however, often depend on the perception that organizations pursue CSR out of a sincere commitment to social and environmental values. Yet many employees question the sincerity of CSR efforts, especially when these initiatives are seen as opportunistic and self-serving. Drawing on cognitive dissonance theory, we develop and empirically test a dual-pathway model explaining employees' behavioural responses to perceived organizational opportunism (i.e., the strategic use of CSR to advance self-interested motives rather than genuine social impact). Across two time-lagged studies conducted in distinct organizational contexts, we demonstrate that such perceptions elicit divergent employee reactions: heightened moral disengagement and symbolic CSR behaviour alongside diminished moral ownership and substantive CSR engagement. We also show that psychological empowerment moderates these mechanisms by weakening the effect of perceived opportunism on moral disengagement and mitigating its adverse effect on moral ownership. Overall, our findings contribute to research on micro-CSR and organizational behaviour by clarifying the moral processes through which employees interpret and respond to inconsistent organizational cues.

□ Lu - When Doing Good Feels Wrong The Dual Influence of Perceived Organizational Oppor.pdf

7. The Great Temporal Divide: How Top Management Team Temporal Faultlines and Dominant Subgroups Shape Firm Innovativeness in Iran

Authors: Shi Tang, Sherry M. B. Thatcher, Andreas W. Richter, Stephen X. Zhang, Asghar Afshar Jahanshahi

DOI: [10.1111/joms.70113](https://doi.org/10.1111/joms.70113)

Published: 2026-05-15

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Top Management Teams, Innovation Management, Organizational Behavior
- **Theories:** Faultline Theory, Upper Echelons Theory, Configurational Perspective, Temporal Orientation

Abstract:

Abstract

While executives vary in attention to the past, present, and future, prior work has largely examined these temporal orientations in isolation or at the individual level, which limits insight into how they jointly configure within top management teams (TMTs) and translate into firm behaviours. In this study, we advance a configurational perspective by introducing TMT temporal faultlines, defined as subgroup divisions based on the alignment of members' past, present, and future foci. We distinguish two key features of temporal faultlines: temporal faultline strength and the dominant subgroup temporal profile, and propose that these configurational properties shape the emergence of TMT time-awareness norms through regulating how teams attend to and coordinate temporal demands. Based on multi-wave survey data from 209 TMTs of small- and medium-sized enterprises in Iran, our findings suggest that temporal faultlines, making temporal differences salient, foster the development of shared norms around time management. We further find that TMT time-awareness norms exhibit an inverted U-shaped relationship with firm innovativeness, with moderate levels enhancing innovativeness by balancing temporal discipline and flexibility. Together, these findings shift research on executive temporality from individual traits to team configurations and extend faultlines theory by showing that both subgroup differentiation and subgroup content matter.

□ Tang - The Great Temporal Divide How Top Management Team Temporal Faultlines and Domina.pdf

Journal of Management

1. There's More Than Meets the Eye: Assessing the Impact of Immigrants on Firm Environmental Performance

Authors: Narae Lee, Heli Wang

DOI: [10.1177/01492063261442451](https://doi.org/10.1177/01492063261442451)

Published: 2026-05-29

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Non-market Strategy, Environmental Management, Corporate Social Responsibility, Public Policy
- **Theories:** Institutional Theory, Attention-Based View, Regulatory Capacity, Institutional Crowding

Abstract:

This study investigates how shifts in political attention across issue domains influence firm environmental performance. We theorize that heightened salience of migration—a politically charged and administratively demanding issue—can crowd out the state's regulatory capacity in unrelated domains such as environmental protection. Drawing on a panel of U.S. manufacturing facilities, we find that increases in migration salience, measured by the volume of migration-related state legislation, are associated with higher levels of toxic pollution. We argue that this occurs as limited public resources and oversight shift toward migration enforcement, weakening the institutional constraints on firms. The effect is more pronounced as states have lower fiscal capacity. These findings are robust to an instrumental variable strategy and alter native speci-

cations. By conceptualizing enforcement capacity as fluid and contested, this study offers new insights into how institutional crowding reshapes the regulatory environment and, in turn, affects firm behavior in the environmental domain.

□ Lee - There's More Than Meets the Eye Assessing the Impact of Immigrants on Firm Envir.pdf

2. Conflict-Situated Cooperation: How Israeli and Palestinian IT Professionals Give Meaning to Cooperating Under Ethnonational Conflict

Authors: Pieter de Wit, Christopher Wickert, Ali Aslan Gümüſay

DOI: [10.1177/01492063261443476](https://doi.org/10.1177/01492063261443476)

Published: 2026-05-18

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Theory, International Business, Sociology of Work, Information Technology Management
- **Theories:** Sensemaking, Social Identity Theory, Conflict-Situated Cooperation, Depoliticization/Politicization

Abstract:

Despite persisting ethnonational conflict in Israel and Palestine, professionals in the information technology (IT) sector keep working together. They engage in professional cooperation by jointly developing software while embedded in societal narratives that cast the other as the enemy. We ask how individuals give meaning to their work when cooperating with their societal adversaries in such a context. Drawing on a qualitative case study that combines interviews, observations, and documents, we find that individuals use two main tactics to cope with the conflict context: depoliticizing and politicizing cooperation. We specify these individual-level tactics and show when they are used: depoliticizing in situations “at work” and politicizing in situations “about work.” We also show that these tactics are at times misplaced and hinder cooperation. Additionally, we find that physical and social interference can disrupt cooperation and thus set guardrails for it. Abstracting from our findings, we theorize a model that explains how individuals engage in what we term conflict-situated cooperation. We offer two main Acknowledgments: We like to thank our informants for their hospitality and reflections that formed the basis of this study. We also thank Sara Soderstrom, Shahzad Ansari, Santi Furnari, Zahira Jaser, Johanna Mair, Martin Kilduff, and members of the OTREG reading group, as well as participants of the Academy of Management Symposium on Organizing and Strategizing in the Face of War, for their valuable comments on earlier versions of the paper. Finally, we thank our editor Fabrice Lumineau and our anonymous reviewers who helped us improve our work in

□ Wit - Conflict-Situated Cooperation How Israeli and Palestinian IT Professionals Give.pdf

3. A Watched Blossom Seldom Blooms: Board Interlocks and Digital Business Model Innovation

Authors: Fangyi Liu, Jingtao Yi, Liang Chen

DOI: [10.1177/01492063261446895](https://doi.org/10.1177/01492063261446895)

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Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Governance, Innovation Management, Digital Transformation
- **Theories:** Network Theory, Attention-Based View, Organizational Learning, Social Network Analysis

Abstract:

Digital business model innovation (DBMI) represents a critical yet challenging form of strategic adaptation for firms navigating modern technological changes. This study investigates how the directionality of board interlock ties—whether ties are sent or received—shapes a focal firm’s engagement in DBMI. Drawing on a coevolutionary stochastic actor-oriented model (SAOM) applied to a longitudinal dataset, our baseline

results reveal an intriguing asymmetry: receiving ties exert a stronger influence on a focal firm's DBMI than sending ties. To probe this divergence, we abductively unpack the underlying diffusion frictions spanning attention, interpretation, and validation. The results point to attention friction as the primary bottleneck: when boards face heightened attentional scarcity, such as when firms experience CEO succession or operate under high business diversification, the relative advantage of receiving ties over sending ties is magnified. Our work deepens the understanding of how the directionality of board interlock ties channels organizational learning to foster strategic adaptation in the digital age.

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4. How Racioethnic Equity Contributes To Organizational Functioning

Authors: Larissa R. Garcia, Kristi B. Hatter, Derek R. Avery, Patrick F. McKay

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Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Human Resource Management, Organizational Behavior, Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion, Strategic Human Capital
- **Theories:** Signaling Theory, Equity Theory, Management Ethnic Representativeness

Abstract:

Although diversity and inclusion have been studied extensively, equity is the relatively underexplored component of DEI. The present study addresses this gap by examining the influence of equity on organization-level outcomes through the lens of management ethnic representativeness (MER), which reflects the alignment between the racioethnic profiles of employees and management. We integrate signaling and equity theories to hypothesize that organizational equity signals elicit employee productivity, ultimately impacting the organization's bottom line. Specifically, we hypothesize that MER has a positive indirect relationship with organizational performance through operational performance, especially in more racioethnically diverse organizations. Our model is tested through three field studies and an experiment (along with two supplemental studies). Across multiple studies including archival national survey data (Study 1), a large, US-based retail organization (Study 2), five years of professional sports panel data (Study 3), and an experiment (Study 4), we found consistent evidence that MER is associated with higher operational performance and, by extension, greater organizational performance, particularly in units with greater racioethnic diversity. Additionally, we observed that MER is related positively to perceived equity when organizations are more racioethnically diverse. We discuss the theoretical and practical implications of our study findings. Keywords: diversity; equity; racioethnic equity; signaling theory; workforce equity *Indicates first authorship is shared and order is alphabetical.

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